



The Honourable Senator Allen
2025
California State Senate
1021 O Street
Sacramento, CA 95814

November 7th,

Dear Senator Allen,

On behalf of the League of California Cities, we are pleased to express our support for SB 33, the Student Voter Empowerment Act. This legislation represents a significant step toward strengthening civic participation among young Californians while ensuring that voter engagement efforts remain nonpartisan, equitable, and respectful of local governance structures.

Cities across California depend on an engaged and informed electorate to sustain effective local democracy. SB 33 advances this foundational principle by expanding opportunities for 16 and 17 year old students to pre-register to vote during annual public school enrollment, and by promoting Student Voting Days across institutions of higher education. These coordinated efforts will help students build early habits of civic involvement and provide them with the tools needed to participate meaningfully in elections at the local and statewide levels.

The League particularly appreciates that SB 33 preserves local flexibility by allowing school districts and campuses to determine the most appropriate methods for distributing pre-registration materials, hosting educational programming, and partnering with nonpartisan civic organizations. This approach recognizes the distinct operational realities of communities across the state and respects the longstanding principle that voter engagement efforts are most effective when locally informed and locally implemented. Additionally, the bill's strong privacy protections and clear safeguards against partisanship help ensure that student information is handled responsibly and that election related activities remain trusted and unbiased.

We also commend SB 33's focus on equity. By directing the Secretary of State to prioritize outreach to disadvantaged schools and rural communities with historically low voter participation, the bill works to close persistent civic engagement gaps and ensure that all young people, regardless of geography or socioeconomic background, have equal access to pre-registration opportunities and high quality civic education.

For these reasons, the League of California Cities is pleased to support SB 33 and respectfully urges its passage. We appreciate your leadership on promoting youth civic engagement and look

forward to continued collaboration on efforts that strengthen California's democratic institutions and empower the next generation of voters.

Sincerely,
Cal Sanchez
League of California Cities